

User Stories

Project: Employee Leave Management System

Version: 1.0

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Status: Draft

US-01 | GAP-01 | Digital Leave Request Submission As an Employee, I want to submit a leave request form on a digital platform, so that I can plan personal commitments without waiting days for a response.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Employee can access the leave request form from their dashboard after logging in
 2. Employee can select start date and end date — overlapping dates with existing approved leave are blocked
 3. Request submits instantly and employee receives email confirmation with a unique reference number within 30 seconds
 4. After submission the system displays an estimated decision timeframe
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US-02 | GAP-02 | Manager Notification and Leave Balance Visibility As a Line Manager, I want to receive instant notification of a leave request and view the employee's leave balance, so that I can respond immediately without checking separate systems.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Line manager receives a system notification within 5 minutes of request submission
 2. Manager dashboard displays approve and reject options alongside the employee's current leave balance
 3. System prevents submission of a rejection without a reason entered
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US-03 | GAP-03 | Automatic Leave Balance Update As an HR Administrator, I want the system to automatically update an employee's leave balance when a request is approved, so that I do not have to update it manually on a spreadsheet.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. A centralised database tracks each employee's leave balance in real time
 2. Leave balance updates automatically within 60 seconds of manager approval
 3. The HR interface reflects the updated balance immediately after the update occurs
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US-04 | GAP-04 | Automatic Payroll Notification As a Payroll Administrator, I want the system to send me an automatic notification when leave is approved and update the payroll record, so that I can process payroll accurately without waiting for manual updates from HR.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. Payroll Administrator receives a system notification containing employee name, leave dates, and leave type within 5 minutes of approval
 2. Payroll record updates automatically from the leave database upon approval
 3. Payroll Administrator has an interface to view and confirm updated payroll records
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US-05 | GAP-05 | Mandatory Rejection Reason As a Line Manager, I want the system to require me to enter a rejection reason before submitting a rejection, so that employees clearly understand why their request was not approved.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. System displays a mandatory text field for rejection reason when the reject option is selected
 2. System displays an error message and prevents submission if the rejection reason field is empty
 3. Employee receives a notification containing the rejection reason within 20 seconds of the manager submitting the decision
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US-06 | GAP-06 | Audit Trail — Planned for Version 2 As an HR Manager, I want the system to display a real-time audit trail of all leave activity across the company, so that I can monitor compliance and resolve disputes accurately.

Acceptance Criteria:

1. System provides an interface displaying real-time leave activity drawn from the central database
2. HR Manager can filter records by employee, month, and year
3. System provides a downloadable report of filtered results